Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on June 14, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	L. Bower
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	A. Khan
		R. Tyler Morin
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Bower called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on May 10, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on May 10, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.3 **Special Meeting**

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the special meeting of the General Government Committee held on May 31, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.3, 4.7 and 4.8 for discussion.

Moved by: J. Dies

That items 4.2, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 4.9, 4.10, 4.11 and 4.12 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 CAO-2021-07: Update to Council Communications Tools & Support Policy

Committee Members discussed the Ward Constituent Newsletter delivery options outlined in the report including costs, climate reduction targets and environmental impacts, opportunities to improve efficiencies, concerns related to layout, design and content, and historical challenges with door to door service delivery.

Committee Members asked questions regarding opportunities to have the Ward Constituent Newsletter on the outside of the Ajax News Advertiser, opportunities for additional print runs, print and distribution costs, staff time and resources, and strategies to measure public feedback with respect to delivery methods. Rachael Wraith, Manager of Corporate Communications and Devon Jarvis, Social Media & Communications Coordinator, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy - #143 update be approved, and

2. That Council approve Ward Constituent Newsletter A delivery option.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That recommendation #2 be amended to read as follows:

   2. That Council approve Ward Constituency Newsletter B delivery option for the remaining 2021 newsletter, and that staff report back to Council following its delivery to determine whether to continue with option B for future newsletter delivery options.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy - #143 update be approved, and

2. That Council approve Ward Constituency Newsletter B delivery option for the remaining 2021 newsletter, and that staff report back to Council following its delivery to determine whether to continue with option B for future newsletter delivery options.

CARRIED

4.2 CAO-2021-09: GR Activities – Q2 2021

Moved by: J. Dies

That the Q2 2021 GR update to Council be received for information.

CARRIED

4.3 CAO-2021-10: Indigenous Community & Healing Garden Project

Committee Members asked questions regarding site location, stakeholder contributions, and Ajax Pickering Hospital Foundation's partnership. Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, responded to questions from Committee Members. Members noted that a portion of proceeds from the Mayor's Gala will be allocated to the Indigenous Community & Healing Garden Project to support homelessness and food security initiatives.

Moved by: S. Collier

That this report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.4 FIN-2021-04: 2020 Development Charge Reserve Funds – Treasurer's Annual Statement

Moved by: J. Dies

That the report "2020 Development Charge Reserve Funds – Treasurer's Annual Statement" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 FIN-2021-03: 2020 Cash in Lieu of Parkland and Cash in Lieu of Parking – Annual Statement

Moved by: J. Dies

That the report "2020 Cash in Lieu of Parkland and Cash in Lieu of Parking - Annual Statement" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.6 **FIN-2021-09: Indexing of Municipal Development Charges – July 1, 2021**

Moved by: J. Dies

That the report on Indexing of Municipal Development Charges be received for information.

CARRIED

4.7 **FIN-2021-10: Health and Dental Benefits – Administrative Services Only (ASO model)**

Committee Members sought clarification regarding annual cost savings ($9,282) and the surplus amount of $928,128.20. Committee Members asked questions regarding mitigation methods for unexpected claims and future opportunities to re-direct surplus funds in the Benefit Claim reserve. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report on the Health and Dental Benefits - Administrative Services Only (ASO model) be received for information.

2. That Council approve the establishment of the Benefits Claim Reserve.

3. That the lump sum payment from Sun Life in the amount of $ 928,128.30 be directed to the new Benefits Claim Reserve.

CARRIED

4.8 **FIN-2021-11: 2022 Budget Timetable**

Committee Members asked questions regarding remedies available to ensure accurate surplus / deficit projections, opportunities to close the books earlier, Town policies with respect to deadlines for submitting departmental invoices, advantages and disadvantages of moving the budget timetable, and opportunities to postpone the forecast. D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: A. Khan

That the report on the 2022 Budget & Forecast Timetable be received for information.

CARRIED

4.9 **LIS-2021-05: Use of Corporate Resources for Election Purposes Policy Update**

Moved by: J. Dies

That the updated Policy 076 - *Use of Corporate Resources for Election Purposes* included as ATT-1 to this report be approved.

CARRIED

4.10 **OES-2021-05: Contract Award – Admiral Road Reconstruction**

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That Council award the contract for Admiral Road Reconstruction to Sanscon Construction Ltd. in the amount of $3,229,966.52 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Staff award the contract for Contract Administration ~ Admiral Road Reconstruction, to R.V. Anderson Associates Limited in the amount of $274,465.70 (inclusive of all taxes).

3. That Council approve the temporary closure of Admiral Road from Parry Road to Roosevelt Avenue from approximately July 2021 to November 2021 in accordance with the Road Occupancy / Road Closure By-Law #04-2021.

CARRIED

4.11 **OES-2021-06: Temporary Road Closure – Fuller Road**

Moved by: J. Dies

That Council approve the temporary closure of Fuller Road from Westney Road South to Clements Road West from approximately June 2021 to November 2021 in accordance with the Road Occupancy / Road Closure By-Law #04-2021.

CARRIED

4.12 **PDS-2021-29: Assumption of Subdivisions – 18T-98016 Hampstock Phase 4 (Pond Block 188 only); 18T-89107 Gates of Ajax**

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That the works and services within the following Plans of Subdivision be assumed by the Town:

   a) (18T-98016) – Hampstock Phase 4 (Pond Block 188 only)
   Owner: Hampstock Dev. Inc. & Aurafields Dev. Ltd.
   Agreement Date: June 30, 2006
   Registered Plan: 40M-2347
   Refer to Appendix “A”

   b) (18T-89107) – Gates of Ajax
   Owner: Abell Dev. Inc.
   Agreement Date: May 10, 2010
   Registered Plan: 40M-2423
   Refer to Appendix “B”

2. That the corresponding Assumption By-laws be prepared for an upcoming Council meeting.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

6. Presentations

6.1 PDS-2021-28: Stormwater Funding Feasibility Study Final Report

Stephen Ruddy, Acting Manager of Development Engineering, reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein.

Pippy Warburton, Project Manager, Aecom, Nancy Hill, Senior Engineer, Aecom, and Mike Gregory, Technical Advisor, Aecom, delivered a presentation regarding stormwater funding feasibility. P. Warburton reviewed project objectives, scope of work, and project conclusions. N. Hill reviewed Ajax's stormwater assets, benchmarking Ajax stormwater management expenditures, stormwater funding including tax implications, recommended stormwater funding levels, and level of service alternatives. M. Gregory discussed funding options, property analysis, stormwater user fees in Canada, pros and cons of user fees, community engagement feedback, conclusions, recommendations, and next steps.

S. Ruddy provided justifications for implementation of the proposed plan.

Committee Members asked questions regarding public open house participation, originating municipality that implemented stormwater user fees, Durham Region's reasons for declining the role of billing agent, local municipal comparators, opportunities to utilize the Town's tax bill as the billing agent, maintenance and rehabilitation costs, downspout stormwater disconnection incentives and impacts, tax exempt properties, property tax implications, flood risks resulting from neglected stormwater maintenance, and alternative billing options. N. Hill, M. Gregory, S. Ruddy, D. Valentim, and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council authorize staff to proceed with the development of an Implementation Strategy, to be presented to Council at a future date.

2. That the Implementation Strategy include the following elements:

    a) Develop a variable user fee based on impervious area and using the Equivalent Residential Unit (ERU) methodology.

    b) Determine an appropriate level of service and funding, including a phasing schedule.

    c) Develop an associated credit program/policy to allow for property owners the opportunity to reduce fees through the implementation of on-site stormwater measures.

CARRIED

Closed Session (3:20 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session (3:20 p.m.)

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (a) and (f) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss a matter of advice that is subject to solicitor-client privilege, including communications necessary for that purpose and a matter pertaining to the security of the property of the municipality or local board.

CARRIED

7.1 **LIS-2021-06: Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation (AMHC) Final Recommendations**

7.2 **OES-2021-07: Corporate Security Assessment Report**

Open Meeting (4:52 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In-Camera

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That all direction approved during the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (4:53 p.m.)

Moved by: A. Khan

That the June 14, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED